

Match the Question to the Approach

CFAN 3091V | Week 5 Monday Workshop

Names: _____ **Date:** _____

Work in pairs. The questions below are written for this exercise; they are not drawn from anyone's actual thesis, so you are free to be blunt about them. None of them is labeled, and that is the point.

The Questions

1. How much nitrate-nitrogen leaves tile-drained corn fields in southern Minnesota during a single drainage season?
2. How do first-generation students in this college decide whether to pursue an honors thesis?
3. Does a cereal rye cover crop reduce spring weed density compared with no cover crop?
4. What does "sustainability" mean to the managers of mid-size dairy operations who use the word in their marketing?
5. How often do food-shelf clients in the metro area report running out of food before the end of the month?
6. Why do some producers abandon a conservation practice after adopting it?
7. Is a plant-based protein isolate as acceptable to consumers as a dairy protein isolate in a frozen dessert?
8. What is the process by which a county water-planning group reaches a decision about a contested drainage project?
9. Does forest thinning change the density of a bird species over five years?
10. What is it like to manage a family farm through a transition to organic certification?
11. How many hours per week do students in this college spend in paid employment during the semester?
12. How do wildlife technicians describe the judgment calls they make when field protocols do not fit the conditions in front of them?

Sorting

1. What would the answer have to look like?

For each question, write the form the answer must take: a number or rate, a pattern across cases, or an account of how something is experienced.

Numbers or rates: _____

Patterns across cases: _____

Accounts of experience or process: _____

2. Name the approach each one requires

Quantitative: _____

Qualitative: _____

Could go either way: _____

3. Your two biggest disagreements

Question number: _____

Why we disagreed:

Question number: _____

Why we disagreed:

4. Rewrite one question so it requires the other approach

Original question number: _____

Rewritten:

What had to change? Name the specific words you altered, not the topic.

5. The conclusion test

One conclusion the original version could support:

One conclusion the rewritten version could support that the original could not:

Closing

The question on this sheet closest to your own, and what that tells you about the approach your thesis will need:
